

GUTWISE

Low-FODMAP Elimination Phase Starter Kit

Everything you need for the first six weeks — the safe-foods list, a two-week meal plan, a printable symptom tracker and a shopping checklist.

gutwise.nexudel.com

Educational information, not medical advice. See the final page.

How to use this kit

This kit covers the elimination phase — the first of three phases, lasting two to six weeks. Its only job is to answer one question: do FODMAPs drive your symptoms at all?

Before you start, please read this

Get a formal diagnosis first. Coeliac disease, inflammatory bowel disease, bile acid malabsorption and several other conditions produce overlapping symptoms and need entirely different treatment — and coeliac screening is unreliable once you have already cut out wheat. If you can, work with a FODMAP-trained dietitian. It is the single change that most improves the odds of finishing with a broad diet.

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THE THREE PHASES, IN ONE PARAGRAPH

Elimination removes high-FODMAP foods across all five groups at once, for two to six weeks, until symptoms settle to a stable baseline. Reintroduction then challenges each group individually to find which ones you personally react to, and at what dose. Maintenance is the diet you land on afterwards: everything you tolerate, freely, with limits only where you found a genuine trigger. The goal is the broadest diet your gut allows — not the safest one you can imagine.

The five FODMAP groups

FODMAP stands for Fermentable Oligosaccharides, Disaccharides, Monosaccharides And Polyols — short-chain carbohydrates the small intestine absorbs poorly. They draw water into the bowel and are fermented rapidly by gut bacteria, producing gas. In a gut with heightened pain signalling, that ordinary distension registers as pain and bloating.

Group	Found in	Common culprits
Fructans	Wheat, rye, some vegetables, added fibres	Onion, garlic, bread, pasta, inulin, chicory root
GOS	Legumes and some nuts	Chickpeas, lentils, kidney beans, cashews, pistachios
Lactose	Dairy	Milk, soft cheese, yoghurt, ice cream, custard
Excess fructose	Some fruit and sweeteners	Honey, apple, pear, mango, high-fructose corn syrup
Polyols	Stone fruit, some vegetables, sweeteners	Peach, plum, mushroom, cauliflower, sorbitol, xylitol

The one idea to take from this page

FODMAP content is a dose, not a property. Almost nothing is universally forbidden — most foods simply have a threshold. A quarter of an avocado is low FODMAP; half is not. FODMAPs also stack, so three portion-safe foods in one sitting can add up to a high-FODMAP meal. This is why every serving size in this kit is stated explicitly.

None of these carbohydrates is harmful. Most are prebiotics that feed beneficial bacteria, which is precisely why this diet is designed to be temporary rather than permanent.

Safe foods (1 of 2)

Low FODMAP at the servings shown. Where no serving is given, the food has no meaningful ceiling at normal portions.

PROTEIN — NO FODMAPS AT ANY PORTION

- Chicken, turkey, beef, pork, lamb
- All fish and shellfish
- Eggs
- Firm tofu (170 g)
- Tempeh (100 g)
- Plain canned tuna and salmon

STARCHES AND GRAINS

- Rice — white, brown, jasmine, basmati
- Potato — no limit
- Quinoa — no practical limit
- Oats, rolled — 1/2 cup dry
- Polenta and cornmeal
- Gluten-free pasta — 1 cup cooked
- Sourdough spelt bread — 2 slices
- Rice noodles

VEGETABLES

- Carrot — no limit
- Cucumber — no limit
- Spinach — 75 g
- Lettuce, all types
- Courgette / zucchini — 65 g
- Green beans — 15 beans
- Bell pepper, red — 43 g
- Bok choy — 1 cup (75 g)
- Aubergine / eggplant — 75 g
- Tomato — 1 medium
- Potato, sweet — 75 g
- Spring onion, green tops only

Safe foods (2 of 2)

FRUIT

- Strawberries — no practical limit
- Blueberries — 20 berries
- Kiwi — 2 small
- Orange — 1 medium
- Banana, firm/unripe — 1 medium
- Grapes — 1 cup
- Pineapple — 1 cup
- Cantaloupe melon — 3/4 cup
- Raspberries — 30 g
- Rhubarb — 1 cup

DAIRY AND ALTERNATIVES

- Lactose-free milk and yoghurt
- Cheddar, parmesan, swiss — aged hard cheeses
- Brie and camembert — 40 g
- Feta — 40 g
- Almond milk — 1 cup
- Macadamia milk — 1 cup
- Butter
- Lactose-free cream

NUTS, SEEDS AND FATS

- Walnuts — 30 g
- Almonds — 10 nuts
- Peanuts and peanut butter — 2 tbsp
- Macadamias — 20 nuts
- Pumpkin seeds — 2 tbsp
- Chia seeds — 2 tbsp
- Olive oil, all plain oils
- Garlic-infused oil — the key ingredient

FLAVOUR — WHERE THE DIET IS WON

- All fresh and dried herbs
- Ginger — no limit
- Turmeric, cumin, paprika, chilli
- Lemon and lime juice
- Soy sauce / tamari — 2 tbsp
- Maple syrup — 2 tbsp
- Sugar (sucrose)
- Vinegars — red wine, white, rice
- Asafoetida — 1/4 tsp, a garlic stand-in
- Chives and spring onion greens

Foods to avoid during elimination

These are high FODMAP at normal servings. Avoiding them is temporary — most will come back during reintroduction, and most people find they tolerate the majority.

Category	Avoid for now
Vegetables	Onion (all types), garlic, cauliflower, mushroom, asparagus, artichoke, leek bulb, sugar snap peas, celery (>5 cm)
Fruit	Apple, pear, mango, watermelon, peach, plum, nectarine, cherry, apricot, blackberry, dried fruit of any kind
Grains	Wheat bread, wheat pasta, couscous, rye, barley, most breakfast cereals, anything with added inulin or chicory root
Legumes	Chickpeas, lentils (>1/4 cup), kidney beans, baked beans, black beans, soy beans, silken tofu
Dairy	Regular milk, soft and cream cheeses, yoghurt, ice cream, custard, condensed and evaporated milk
Nuts	Cashews and pistachios — these two are notably high in GOS
Sweeteners	Honey, agave, high-fructose corn syrup, and anything ending in -ol: sorbitol, mannitol, xylitol, maltitol, isomalt
Drinks	Apple and pear juice, chai, chamomile and fennel tea, rum, sweetened soft drinks

A note on tone

This is a list of foods to set aside for a few weeks, not a list of dangerous things. Nothing here will damage you, and treating the list as a minefield tends to make people more restricted rather than better informed. If you eat something on it, you may have symptoms for a day — then you carry on. There is no need to restart the clock.

The eight places an elimination usually fails

When someone reports that the diet "did nothing", the cause is almost always on this list rather than a genuine non-response. Check every one of these in week one.

- Stock cubes and liquid stock — the single most common culprit. Onion and garlic appear as "natural flavouring" or "vegetable extract" rather than being named.
- Pre-marinated or basted meat — supermarket chicken is very often seasoned with garlic before you buy it.
- "High-fibre" and "gut-healthy" products — inulin and chicory root fibre are concentrated fructans, and they are added to exactly the products marketed as good for digestion.
- Protein powders and bars — frequently sweetened with sorbitol, xylitol or high-fructose corn syrup.
- Sugar-free gum and mints — polyols, often several servings a day without anyone counting them.
- Salad dressings and mayonnaise — garlic powder is close to universal.
- Curry pastes, stir-fry sauces and gravy — assume these contain allium unless the label proves otherwise.
- Oat milk poured over oats — a good low-FODMAP choice in coffee, but it stacks with the oats themselves.

The fix for most of this

Buy one stock certified by Monash or FODMAP Friendly, and one bottle of commercially prepared garlic-infused oil. Those two purchases remove more accidental exposure than anything else you can do. Do not infuse garlic oil yourself and store it — garlic in oil is a low-oxygen environment that can support *Clostridium botulinum*.

Two-week meal plan — week 1

Deliberately repetitive. Week one is cognitively demanding, and reducing the number of daily decisions matters more than variety. Every meal here is low FODMAP at one serving.

Day	Breakfast	Lunch	Dinner
Mon	Overnight oats, strawberries	Quinoa bowl, feta, cucumber	Lemon herb chicken, potatoes
Tue	Overnight oats, strawberries	Leftover chicken, spinach	Tomato basil pasta (GF)
Wed	Eggs, sourdough spelt toast	Quinoa bowl, tinned tuna	Ginger carrot soup, rice
Thu	Overnight oats, blueberries	Leftover soup	Sheet-pan salmon, bok choy, rice
Fri	Eggs, tomato, chives	Quinoa bowl, chicken	Tomato basil pasta (GF)
Sat	Lactose-free yoghurt, walnuts	Omelette, cheddar, spinach	Lemon herb chicken, potatoes
Sun	Eggs, sourdough spelt toast	Leftover chicken salad	Roast beef, carrots, rice

SNACKS, ANY DAY

- Three peanut butter and oat energy bites
- A firm banana, or ten strawberries
- A small handful of walnuts (30 g) or almonds (10 nuts)
- Rice cakes with peanut butter (2 tbsp)
- 40 g cheddar with a few gluten-free crackers

Two-week meal plan — week 2

By now the basics are automatic, so week two adds a little more variety. Keep tracking symptoms daily — you are looking for a trend across the fortnight, not a verdict on any single day.

Day	Breakfast	Lunch	Dinner
Mon	Overnight oats, kiwi	Quinoa bowl, olives, feta	Sheet-pan salmon, rice
Tue	Eggs, spinach, chives	Leftover salmon, cucumber	Beef stir-fry, rice, ginger
Wed	Lactose-free yoghurt, berries	Jacket potato, cheddar, tuna	Ginger carrot soup, spelt toast
Thu	Overnight oats, strawberries	Leftover stir-fry	Lemon herb chicken, potatoes
Fri	Eggs, sourdough spelt toast	Quinoa bowl, chicken	Tomato basil pasta, parmesan
Sat	Oats, maple syrup, walnuts	Omelette, tomato, feta	Roast pork, potatoes, green beans
Sun	Eggs, tomato, spelt toast	Leftover roast, salad	Prawn rice noodles, bok choy

Cooking rules that make all of this work

Use garlic-infused oil as your default cooking fat. Use spring onion greens wherever a recipe says onion. Season with herbs, ginger, lemon, soy sauce and plenty of salt and pepper. Use certified stock, or plain water plus more seasoning. That is genuinely the whole technique.

Shopping checklist

Covers roughly one week for one person. Tick as you go.

BUY THESE FIRST — THEY DO THE HEAVY LIFTING

- | | |
|---|---|
| ☐ Garlic-infused olive oil (certified) | ☐ Lactose-free milk |
| ☐ Certified low-FODMAP stock | ☐ The Monash University FODMAP app |

FRESH

- | | |
|--|--|
| ☐ Chicken thighs | ☐ Courgette |
| ☐ Salmon fillets | ☐ Green beans |
| ☐ Beef or pork | ☐ Strawberries |
| ☐ Eggs | ☐ Blueberries |
| ☐ Carrots | ☐ Firm bananas |
| ☐ Potatoes | ☐ Oranges |
| ☐ Cucumber | ☐ Spring onions |
| ☐ Spinach | ☐ Fresh ginger |
| ☐ Cherry tomatoes | ☐ Lemons |
| ☐ Bok choy | ☐ Parsley and basil |

STORE CUPBOARD

- | | |
|--|---|
| ☐ Jasmine or basmati rice | ☐ Peanut butter (no honey) |
| ☐ Quinoa | ☐ Maple syrup |
| ☐ Rolled oats | ☐ Chia seeds |
| ☐ Gluten-free pasta | ☐ Walnuts |
| ☐ Rice noodles | ☐ Soy sauce or tamari |
| ☐ Canned chopped tomatoes | ☐ Sesame oil |
| ☐ Tomato paste | ☐ Olive oil |
| ☐ Canned tuna | ☐ Dried oregano and cumin |

CHILLED

- | | |
|---|--|
| ☐ Lactose-free yoghurt | ☐ Feta |
| ☐ Cheddar | ☐ Butter |
| ☐ Parmesan | ☐ Sourdough spelt bread |

Weekly symptom tracker

Print one copy per week. Recall across six weeks is genuinely unreliable — without a written record you will finish the phase unable to say clearly whether it worked. Score each symptom 0 (none) to 10 (worst). Track sleep and stress too: both move IBS symptoms independently of food, and without those columns you will misattribute a bad week.

	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun
Bloating (0–10)							
Abdominal pain (0–10)							
Wind (0–10)							
Urgency (0–10)							
Bowel habit (type 1–7)							
Energy (0–10)							
Sleep (hours)							
Stress (0–10)							
Anything off-plan?							

NOTES FOR THE WEEK

How to read a label in ten seconds

You do not need to understand the whole ingredients list. You are scanning for a short set of words, and they cluster near the top of the list where quantities are largest.

RED-FLAG WORDS — PUT IT BACK

- Onion, onion powder, shallot, garlic, garlic powder
- Inulin, chicory root, chicory root fibre, FOS, oligofructose
- Honey, agave, high-fructose corn syrup, fruit juice concentrate
- Anything ending in -ol: sorbitol, mannitol, xylitol, maltitol, isomalt
- Wheat flour, rye, barley, malt extract
- Milk solids, whey powder, milk powder
- "Natural flavouring" or "vegetable extract" in a savoury product — this is where allium usually hides

GREEN-FLAG WORDS — USUALLY FINE

- Rice flour, corn flour, potato starch, tapioca
- Cane sugar, sucrose, glucose, dextrose, maple syrup
- Lactose-free milk, aged cheeses
- Garlic-infused oil (as distinct from garlic)
- Herbs, spices, salt, vinegar, citric acid

When the label is genuinely ambiguous

Check the Monash app first. If the product is not listed and the ingredients are unclear, leave it for now and revisit during reintroduction — a single unknown is not worth risking a muddy result in the one phase that is meant to give you a clean answer.

What happens next

The elimination phase ends. That is the part most people are not told clearly enough, and it is the single most consequential thing in this document.

IF YOUR SYMPTOMS IMPROVED

Hold the baseline for another week or two to be confident, then move to reintroduction. Do not linger in elimination because it feels safe — lingering is the most common mistake in the entire protocol.

Elimination tells you only that FODMAPs matter. It does not tell you which ones, and that is the piece of information that actually changes your diet.

IF NOTHING CHANGED AFTER SIX WEEKS

Stop, and go back to your clinician. Continuing has no further diagnostic value. Roughly a quarter of people with IBS do not respond to this diet, and small intestinal bacterial overgrowth, bile acid malabsorption, coeliac disease, endometriosis and pelvic floor dysfunction all mimic IBS while needing entirely different treatment. Before you conclude anything, re-check the hidden-FODMAP list on page 7 — an overlooked stock cube invalidates the whole experiment.

What success actually looks like

Not "I found the foods I can eat." Success is finishing all three phases eating a wide, varied, socially normal diet in which you limit two or three specific things and know exactly why. Most people who complete reintroduction properly discover they react to only one or two groups and tolerate the rest without difficulty. Long-term blanket restriction measurably reduces gut microbiome diversity — the elimination phase is scaffolding, and scaffolding comes down.

The full reintroduction protocol — which test food to use for each group, the three-day dosing schedule, washout periods and how to read ambiguous results — is on the site at gutwise.nexudel.com/guides/reintroduction-protocol/

Important information

MEDICAL DISCLAIMER

GutWise publishes educational information, not medical advice. This document is not a substitute for personalised assessment, diagnosis or treatment by a qualified healthcare professional, and no clinician-patient relationship is created by reading it.

The low-FODMAP diet is an elimination protocol intended to be followed short-term with support from a registered dietitian. It is not a weight-loss diet and should not be used as one — doing so carries a documented risk of disordered eating in this population. It is not appropriate for everyone, and it is not appropriate for anyone who has not first been formally assessed.

Always speak to a qualified healthcare professional before changing your diet, particularly if you have not been formally diagnosed, are pregnant or breastfeeding, have a history of disordered eating, or are managing another medical condition.

Seek prompt medical attention for any of the following, which are not features of IBS: unintentional weight loss, blood in your stool, fever, persistent vomiting, difficulty swallowing, anaemia, symptoms that wake you at night, or a first onset of symptoms after age 50.

ABOUT THE SERVING SIZES

Portion thresholds reflect published Monash University laboratory testing at the time of writing. FODMAP data is revised as new foods are analysed and as existing foods are re-tested, so the Monash University FODMAP app remains the authoritative and current source. Where this document and the app disagree, follow the app.

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Recipes with tested portion limits, phase-by-phase guides, and honest product picks.